Task 1: Discovery and Requirements

Final Project - Task 1 | Digital Loan Pre-Approval & Onboarding (MVP), Online Bank | Prepared by: [Your Name], Business Analyst | 09 November 2026

Part 1: Interview Plan

Stakeholder roles

Group	Represents	What we need from them
Product team	Business goals, features, customer experience	Objectives, journey, scope, success metrics
Compliance team	Legal and regulatory alignment	Consent, KYC/CIP, audit, retention, notices
Operations team	Workflow efficiency and manual review	Routing rules, SLA, capacity, exception handling

Interview objectives

- Understand the onboarding flow and business goals
- Identify compliance and audit requirements
- Discover operational constraints and manual review processes
- Clarify functional and non-functional requirements
- Expose potential risks and gaps

> **AI prompt used:** *Generate 10 role-based discovery interview questions for product, compliance, and operations stakeholders for a digital loan onboarding system at an online bank. Focus on business objectives, user experience expectations, compliance requirements, and operational constraints. Group the questions by role.*

10 role-based interview questions

ID	Role	Question
P1	Product	What business outcomes must the MVP deliver in its first 6 months (e.g., conversion, time to decision, cost per application)?
P2	Product	Walk me through the ideal customer journey from loan offer to pre-approval. Where do customers drop out today?
P3	Product	Which loan products, amounts and terms are in scope for automated pre-approval, and which must always go to a human?
P4	Product	What is an acceptable time for customers to receive a decision on web and mobile, and what happens if it takes longer?
C1	Compliance	What consents and disclosures must we capture before the soft credit pull, and how must they be stored and evidenced?
C2	Compliance	Which KYC/CIP data elements and verification methods are mandatory, and what should happen when identity cannot be verified?
C3	Compliance	What audit, data-retention and adverse-action notice requirements apply to automated decisions?
O1	Operations	Which cases should be routed to manual review, and what SLA and staffing constraints does your team have?
O2	Operations	What information do agents need on one screen to make a fast, consistent review decision?
O3	Operations	How should the process behave when third-party services (KYC, credit bureau) are slow or unavailable?

Review note: each question was checked against the five interview objectives; O3 (third-party failure handling) was included because vendor outages directly affect operations and customers.

Part 2: Simulated Stakeholder Interviews

> **AI prompt used:** *Act as a [Product Owner / Compliance Officer / Operations Lead] at an online bank. Answer the following interview question about digital loan onboarding realistically. Identify any assumptions, unknowns, dependencies, or missing controls in your response: [question].*

Q	Stakeholder (AI-simulated)	Answer (summary)	Assumptions / gaps identified
P1	Product Owner	We want 60% of started applications completed, a decision in under 5 minutes for most customers, and a 30% lower cost per application than branch lending.	Baseline conversion data not yet available; 'most customers' needs a target (proposed: 85% auto-decided).
P2	Product Owner	Customer sees an offer, clicks Apply, gives consent, enters details, and gets a pre-approval on screen. Today most drop out at document upload and long forms.	Document upload is out of MVP scope, so forms must stay short; field list not defined.
P3	Product Owner	Unsecured personal loans, $1,000 to $50,000, 12-60 months. Anything above $50k or with joint applicants goes to an agent.	Joint applications not covered; confirm whether they are rejected or routed to agents.
C1	Compliance Officer	Customers must give explicit consent to a soft inquiry and accept e-sign and privacy disclosures. We must store who consented, when, from which device, and the disclosure version.	Assumes a US regulatory context (FCRA, GLBA, E-SIGN). Consent text must be versioned; no requirement yet for consent withdrawal.
C2	Compliance Officer	CIP requires name, date of birth, address and ID number, verified through our KYC provider and a sanctions/watchlist screen. Unverified identity cannot be auto-approved.	Missing control: what happens on a partial match? Proposed: route to manual review, never auto-decline.
C3	Compliance Officer	Every decision must be explainable with reason codes, logged immutably, and kept per our retention policy. Declined applicants must receive adverse-action notices.	Retention period not stated (assumed 7 years, to confirm). Model and rule versions must be logged with each decision.
O1	Operations Lead	Borderline credit scores, KYC partial matches and any system failure. We can handle about 150 cases a day with a 4-business-hour SLA.	Volume risk: if more than 15% of applications go to review, the SLA will break.
O2	Operations Lead	Applicant summary, KYC result and mismatch details, credit attributes, rule that triggered review, and a notes field. Decisions need one click plus a reason.	Role-based access needed so agents see only what they need (masked SSN).
O3	IT Lead (for Ops)	Retry the bureau up to 3 times with backoff. If it still fails, pause the application and tell the customer we will follow up, instead of declining.	RTO/RPO and availability targets not yet agreed; vendor SLA unknown.
P4	Product Owner	Under 3 minutes end-to-end on both channels. If longer, show a progress screen and send an email when ready.	Conflict: Product wants under 3 min, Ops review SLA is 4 hours. Resolution: the 3-min target applies to auto-decisions only.

Insights and gaps

Type	Finding	Action
Missing requirement	Partial KYC match handling not defined	BR-03: route partial matches to manual review
Missing requirement	Consent withdrawal and disclosure versioning	Add to FR-02 and data model (Consent entity)
Conflict	Product's 3-minute target vs Ops 4-hour review SLA	3-minute target applies to auto-decisions; review cases get a separate SLA
Risk	Manual review volume above 15% would break the SLA	Monitor review rate KPI; tune thresholds in UAT
Unclear rule	Credit thresholds and DTI limits not stated	Proposed thresholds (680 / 600, DTI 40%) to confirm with Risk
Unclear rule	Data retention period	Assumed 7 years; Compliance to confirm

Type	Finding	Action
Dependency	Credit bureau and KYC vendor SLAs unknown	Obtain vendor SLAs; design retry and fallback (BR-06)

Part 3: Requirements Pack

Functional requirements

ID	Functional requirement
FR-01	Customer starts an application on web or mobile and can save and resume within 30 days
FR-02	Capture and log explicit consent (soft pull, e-sign, privacy) with timestamp, device and disclosure version
FR-03	Capture personal, KYC/CIP and income data with field validation
FR-04	Verify identity and screen watchlists via the KYC Service
FR-05	Perform a soft credit pull via the Credit Bureau API
FR-06	Decision engine applies business rules and returns approve / decline / manual review with reason codes
FR-07	Route review cases to a manual review queue with SLA tracking
FR-08	Notify customers of status and decision by email/SMS/in-app, including adverse-action notices
FR-09	Write every consent, data access and decision to an immutable audit log
FR-10	Create the application record in Core Banking on decision

Non-functional requirements

ID	Category	Requirement (measurable)
NFR-01	Latency	Automated decision returned within 3 minutes for 95% of applications; API p95 < 2 s
NFR-02	Throughput	Handle 50 applications per minute at peak (3x expected launch volume)
NFR-03	Availability	99.9% monthly for customer-facing services
NFR-04	RTO / RPO	Recovery time 4 hours; recovery point 15 minutes
NFR-05	Data retention	Application, consent and audit data kept 7 years (to confirm with Compliance), then purged
NFR-06	Security & privacy	Encryption in transit (TLS 1.2+) and at rest; SSN tokenized; role-based access; MFA for staff
NFR-07	Auditability	Audit log is append-only, tamper-evident, and searchable by application ID
NFR-08	Accessibility	Web and mobile meet WCAG 2.1 AA

MoSCoW prioritization

Priority	Requirements
Must	KYC/CIP verification; customer consent capture & logging; soft credit pull; automated pre-approval decision with reason codes; audit logging; web + mobile channels; adverse-action notice
Should	Manual review queue with 4-hour SLA tracking; email/SMS notifications; save-and-resume; retry/backoff for third-party APIs
Could	In-app agent chat; OCR / pre-filled forms from bank data; progress tracker with estimated time
Won't (MVP)	Cross-sell offers; multilingual UI; document upload; joint applications; hard credit pull and funding automation

User stories with acceptance criteria

ID	User story	Acceptance criteria (Given / When / Then)
US-01	As a applicant, I want to start a loan application on web or mobile, so that I can apply anytime from any device.	Given the customer is on the loan offer page When they click Apply and choose a loan amount and term Then an application is created with status "Started" and a unique ID

ID	User story	Acceptance criteria (Given / When / Then)
US-02	As a applicant, I want to review and accept the soft-pull and privacy disclosures, so that I understand how my data is used.	Given the consent screen is displayed When the customer ticks all required consents and continues Then the consent is saved with timestamp, device and disclosure version, and the soft pull is enabled
US-03	As a applicant, I want to enter my personal and identity details in one short form, so that applying is quick.	Given the customer has given consent When they submit all mandatory KYC fields Then the form validates the fields and the status changes to "Submitted"
US-04	As a compliance officer, I want every applicant's identity verified before any decision, so that we meet KYC/CIP rules.	Given an application is submitted When the KYC Service returns a full match and no watchlist hit Then the application status updates to "Verified"
US-05	As a applicant, I want a soft credit check that doesn't hurt my credit score, so that I can see my options risk-free.	Given the identity is verified and soft-pull consent exists When the system calls the Credit Bureau API Then a soft inquiry is recorded and the credit score is stored on the application
US-06	As a applicant, I want an instant pre-approval decision, so that I know where I stand within minutes.	Given the credit score is >= 680 and DTI <= 40% When the decision engine runs Then the status becomes "Pre-approved" and the offer is shown within 3 minutes
US-07	As a operations analyst, I want borderline cases in a review queue with all key data on one screen, so that I can decide quickly and consistently.	Given an application meets a manual-review rule When it is routed to the queue Then the case appears with KYC, credit and trigger reason, and an SLA timer starts at 4 business hours
US-08	As a applicant, I want to be notified when my application status changes, so that I don't need to keep checking.	Given the decision has been made When the status changes to Pre-approved, Declined or In review Then an email/SMS is sent within 1 minute, and declined applicants receive an adverse-action notice
US-09	As a auditor, I want an immutable record of every consent and decision, so that we can prove compliance in an audit.	Given any consent, data access or decision occurs When the event is processed Then an append-only log entry stores actor, action, timestamp and rule version
US-10	As a applicant, I want my application to continue even if a partner service is slow, so that I'm not declined because of a system error.	Given the Credit Bureau API times out When the system retries 3 times with backoff and still fails Then the application moves to "Pending - service delay" and the customer is told we will follow up

Note: the stakeholder answers are AI-simulated for this exercise and must be validated in real interviews before baselining the requirements.